

Taskmint (TNImpact) vs Zoho Books vs Tally (what's different)

What each one is “best for”

- **Taskmint (TNImpact):** A lightweight **MSME order + inventory + invoice + customer-store + automations** app, with a **low-code “Database Builder”** to create custom tables and store records (including an auto-created Orders table).
 - **Zoho Books:** A full **cloud accounting** product (invoicing + GST/accounting compliance + bank flows + receivables/payables + audit-grade reports).
 - **Tally:** A mature **accounting-first** system (often on-prem / local), strong for **accounts + GST + vouchers + ledgers** and accountant workflows.
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Where Taskmint is stronger than Zoho Books / Tally

- **Customer storefront built-in:**
Taskmint includes a public **customer store route** (/store) where customers can browse products and place orders.
 - **Order lifecycle operations:** Taskmint has explicit seller actions (**accept / reject / ship / complete**) and **order tracking events** stored in OrderTracking.
 - **Automations focused on operations:** Includes **low-stock automation** that generates a **WhatsApp link** message to a manager number.
 - **Low-code Database Builder:**
Taskmint lets you create **custom tables and fields**, and it auto-creates a default **Orders** table and adds a record for each order.
 - **Self-hostable + data control:** Taskmint runs on **Flask + SQLite + React** (you can host it yourself); Zoho Books is SaaS, Tally is typically local/proprietary.
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Where Zoho Books / Tally are stronger than Taskmint

- **Real accounting (core gap):**
- **Zoho Books/Tally:** ledgers, chart of accounts, vouchers, reconciliation, accounting rules, GST filings workflows, audit-grade reporting.

- **Taskmint:**
tracks **sales records** (creates a SalesRecord when an order is completed) and exports **sales CSV**, but it is **not a full accounting system**.
- **Compliance depth:**
- **Zoho/Tally** generally support broader compliance/reporting expectations.
- **Taskmint** currently focuses on operational GST calculation at product/order level (GST slab + type stored; GST totals in invoices/emails/CSV).
- **Enterprise features:**
- Multi-branch, complex roles/permissions, approvals, advanced taxation edge-cases, integrations, etc. are typically stronger in Zoho/Tally.

Feature-by-feature differences (grounded in Taskmint code)

- **Products & Inventory**
- **Taskmint:** product list with stock; stock reduces on **order completion**.
- **Zoho/Tally:** broader inventory valuation and accounting integration.
- **GST**
- **Taskmint:** stores **gst_slab** (0/5/18/40) and a single **gst_type** (cgst/sgst/igst). Order items store **gst_rate + gst_amount**; invoice & emails show GST totals.
- **Zoho/Tally:** deeper GST configuration and reporting.
- **Invoices**
- **Taskmint:** generates invoice view + print; includes logo from /logo.png if available; uses A4 portrait print CSS; also has a PDF generator in InvoicePrint.jsx.
- **Zoho/Tally:** mature invoice templates, numbering rules, branding, etc.
- **Customer communications**
- **Taskmint:** sends emails for **accepted/rejected/shipped/completed** with item + GST details via **Gmail SMTP** using seller login email (requires Gmail App Password saved).
- **Zoho Books:** built-in email delivery pipelines; Tally varies by setup.
- **Reports**

- **Taskmint:**
monthly/yearly **sales summary endpoint** + **downloadable CSV** listing customer /order/item details (for completed orders).
 - **Zoho/Tally:** full financial statements and analytics.
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Biggest “positioning” difference (how to explain to judges)

- **Zoho Books / Tally** are **accounting systems**.
- **Taskmint** is an **operations system for MSMEs** (orders, inventory movement, customer updates, invoices, automations) **plus** a **low-code database builder** for custom business tables—so MSMEs can tailor the system without buying a heavy ERP.